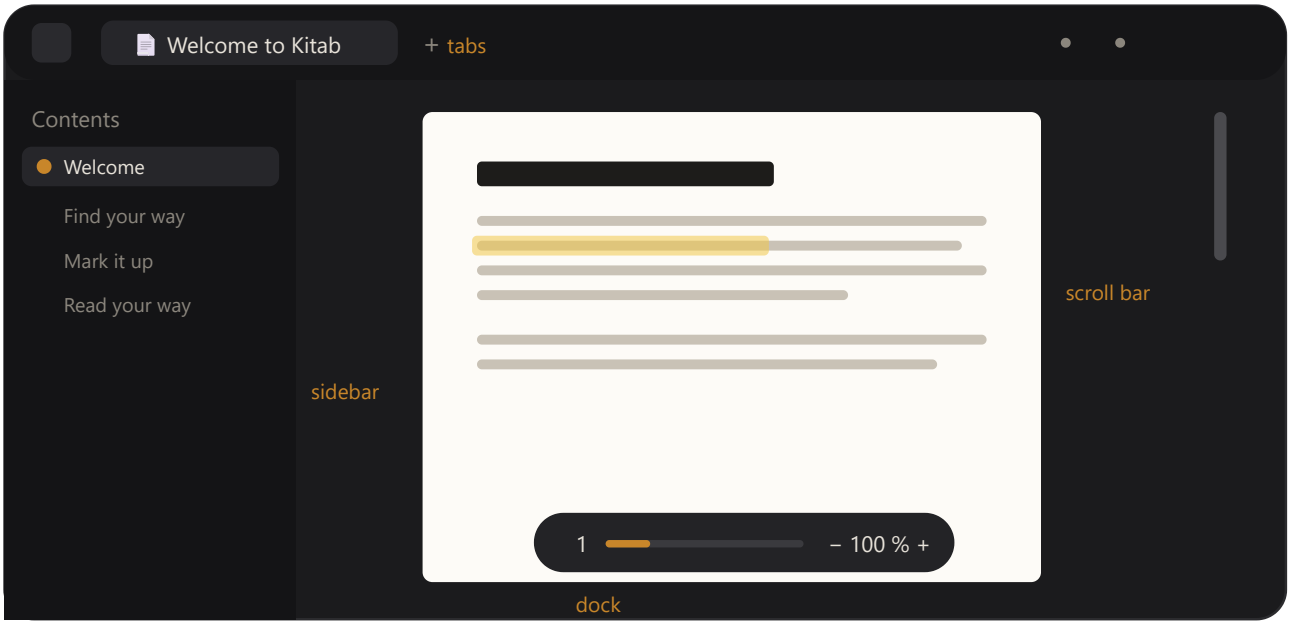
KITAB READER · A SHORT GUIDE

Welcome to Kitab

A reader for your PDFs and books that opens fast, stays out of the way, and keeps your files on your computer.



The window: tabs along the top, contents and bookmarks on the left, the page in the middle, and the dock at the bottom for paging and zoom.

Open something

Drop a file onto the window, press Ctrl + O, or use **Open file…** on Home. Each document gets its own tab, and Kitab remembers the page you were on, so closing a book never loses your place. Home lists what you read lately, with how far through each one you are.

PDF and XPS
Forms, passwords, signatures and annotations work.

EPUB, MOBI, FB2, TXT
Laid out as pages in your theme's colours.

Comics (CBZ)
One page at a time, full width.

Markdown
With code colours, math and diagrams, and an editor beside it.

GETTING AROUND

Find your way 🧭

The sidebar holds the book's contents, your bookmarks, the pages and the marks you've made. Click any entry to jump there; Alt + ← takes you back to where you were. The dock at the bottom shows the page number: drag its slider to move through the book, or click the number and type a page.

Search

Ctrl + F finds words in the open document, and F3 steps through the matches. The search box on Home looks through every document you have opened, and a result opens at the page it found.

Keys worth knowing

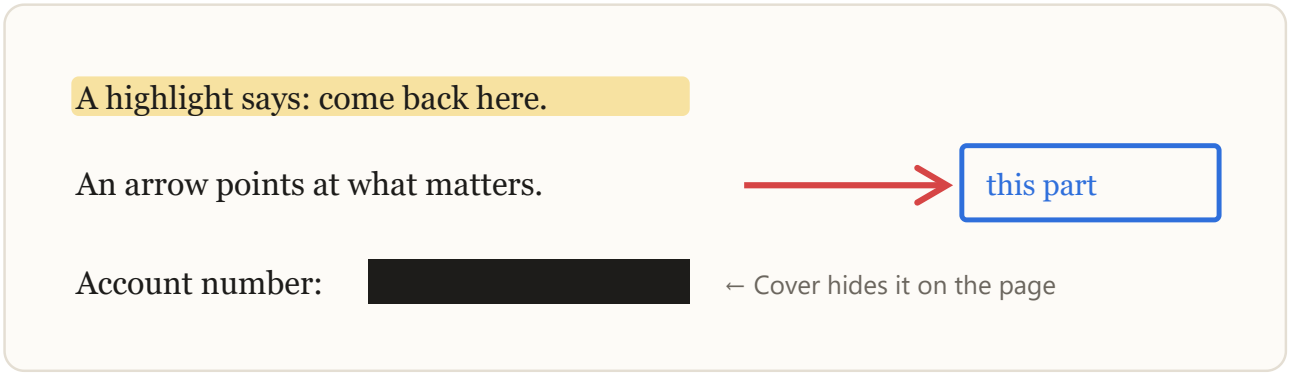
Next and previous page	→ ← or N P
Go to a page	Ctrl + G
Contents and bookmarks	Ctrl + B
Bookmark this page	Ctrl + D
Zoom in and out	Ctrl + = Ctrl + -
Fit the page or the width	Ctrl + 0 Ctrl + 2
Reopen the tab you closed	Ctrl + Shift + T
Every command, by name	Ctrl + K
All shortcuts	Ctrl + /

Tab moves through the buttons with the keyboard, and Enter presses the one that's ringed.

MAKING NOTES

Mark it up ✍️

Press Ctrl + Shift + D for the markup tools: a pen, a highlighter, lines, arrows, boxes, text and sticky notes. Select some text and press H to highlight it. In a PDF, Ctrl + S saves your marks into the file as ordinary annotations, so any other reader shows them too.



Highlights, arrows, boxes and a cover, as they look on a page.

🔒 **About covers.** The Cover tool draws a solid box over something, on screen and in print. The words underneath are still in the file, so don't send a covered PDF to hide a secret.

Passwords, signatures and pages

The lock in the title bar puts a password on a copy of a PDF, or takes one off. **Sign…** in the ⋯ menu signs a PDF with your certificate, and Kitab checks the signatures already in a file when it opens. **Page tools…** deletes, moves and turns pages, compresses a file, and adds page numbers or a watermark. Each of these saves a new file and leaves the original alone.

MAKE IT YOURS

Read your way 🌙

Kitab comes with several themes, from Paper to Ink; Ctrl+Shift+L moves to the next one, and Settings (Ctrl+,) holds the rest: the accent colour, how dense the interface is, where the tabs and dock sit, and the typeface and margins for books.

F11 is focus mode: the tabs, sidebar and dock step aside and the page has the screen. The small buttons in the bottom-right corner bring back the contents or end focus mode. F5 presents a document full screen, one page at a time.

Every script, the right way round

Bangla	বই পড়া আনন্দের।
Hindi	किताब पढ़ना अच्छा है।
Arabic	الكِتابُ خَيْرُ جَلِيسٍ
Japanese	本を読むのは楽しい。
Emoji	📚 ✍️ 🚀 🌙 🧉

Yours, and only yours

Kitab sends nothing about you or your files anywhere. The only time it goes online is a quick check for a new version, which you can turn off in Settings › About. Your library, reading positions and marks stay in a small database on this computer.

Kitab Reader is free software under the GNU AGPL 3.0, made by t21. Source, issues and new versions: github.com/t21dev/kitab. You can delete this guide from Home whenever you like; Settings › Advanced has it back.